Activity 4: Starbucks: Redesign the Third-Place Journey

Course C233

Objective

Use a service-brand strategy to differentiate a real customer journey

Documented real-event basis

Starbucks states a mission centred on coffee, the human spirit, connection and belonging, expressed through person, cup and neighbourhood.

Scenario

An independent Singapore neighbourhood café is losing customers to delivery apps and chain competitors. It wants to become the preferred place for quiet weekday connection without imitating Starbucks.

Primary source

https://about.starbucks.com/mission/

Training assumptions

• The café, customer data, budget and constraints are fictional training inputs.

• Its priority segment is hybrid workers and nearby residents seeking calm, reliable social connection.

• The café can adjust layout, booking, host behaviour, menu presentation and community programming.

• Any concept must maintain seat turnover and accessibility rather than maximise dwell time alone.

Questions

1. What customer job and emotional outcome should define the café's position?

2. Which 7Ps currently contradict the intended brand experience?

3. Which three moments could become distinctive and difficult to copy?

4. How will the team balance belonging, accessibility and commercial viability?

Expected output

Current/future journey map and three-minute differentiated service concept pitch

Acceptance test

The future journey targets a defined audience, aligns all 7Ps, contains three signature moments with operational enablers, and addresses accessibility and viability trade-offs.